English Orbit

PART 1 OF 6 / Pre-A1

Starter

Build your first sentences. Say hello and describe your world.

Read. Listen. Write. Speak. Understand.

An original coursebook companion to the interactive English Orbit course. Four connected lessons combine language explanations with practical activities and guided review.

Included in this part: language focus, vocabulary, reading passages, grammar practice, listening scripts, speaking tasks, writing tasks, a level checkpoint and answer keys.

For independent learners, classrooms and teacher-led study. All teaching content is in English.

Use the course alongside the book

Open English Orbit to hear lesson passages and model sentences. Select this level and the matching lesson.

CEFR labels indicate the intended language focus. This compact companion is not a complete CEFR syllabus or an official proficiency qualification.

Your route through this part

Build your first sentences. Say hello and describe your world.

Four lessons, one clear sequence

01 Hello, world | Names & introductions

02 Things around me | A / an & simple nouns

03 My family | Possessives & people

04 A simple day | Basic verbs & time

How to study a lesson

1. Read for the overall meaning. Read again and notice the language focus.
2. Learn the four key words. Make your own example for each word.
3. Complete the reading and grammar practice before checking the answers.
4. Listen without reading first. Write a dictation, then compare it with the script.
5. Speak aloud, record if possible, and reflect on your delivery.
6. Write a response, review it and revise at least one sentence.

> Suggested rhythm: 25-40 minutes in the app, plus 20-30 minutes of book practice per lesson. Take breaks and repeat difficult activities rather than rushing to the next level.

Use a notebook for extended answers. Listening can use the app, a teacher or a study partner. The PDF contains scripts and tasks; it does not contain embedded audio.

For open questions, wording may differ from the sample answers. For speaking and writing, use the review criteria; there is no single correct personal response.

Before lesson one

Your first words and sounds

The alphabet

A B C D E F G H I J K L M
N O P Q R S T U V W X Y Z

Letters are not the same as sounds. The vowel letters are A, E, I, O and U. A letter can have different sounds in different words. Listen to the alphabet button in the Starter section, repeat, then spell your name.

Numbers 0-20

0 zero · 1 one · 2 two · 3 three · 4 four · 5 five · 6 six · 7 seven · 8 eight · 9 nine · 10 ten · 11 eleven · 12 twelve · 13 thirteen · 14 fourteen · 15 fifteen · 16 sixteen · 17 seventeen · 18 eighteen · 19 nineteen · 20 twenty

A useful first exchange

A: Hello. What is your name?
B: My name is Maya.
A: How do you spell it?
B: M-A-Y-A.

Say your name and spell it. Count five objects near you. Write five numbers in words.

Everyday language

Repeat, notice and use

Colours

red · blue · green · yellow · orange · purple · black · white

My bag is blue. The apple is red. The chair is black.

Days of the week

Monday · Tuesday · Wednesday · Thursday · Friday · Saturday · Sunday

Use a capital letter for days. Say: Today is Monday. I study on Tuesday.

First classroom phrases

Please. / Thank you. / Excuse me. / Sorry.
I do not understand.
Could you repeat that, please?
What does this word mean?

Try it

1. Name three colours you can see.
2. Say the days in order.
3. Write: Today is ...
4. Ask a partner to repeat a word politely.

Hello, world

LANGUAGE FOCUS / Names & introductions

01 / Read and notice

Hello! My name is Maya. I am a student. I am from Canada. This is my friend, Leo. He is from Italy. We are in an English class. Our teacher is Anna. She is kind.

Language focus

Use I am, you are, he/she is and we/they are. In conversation: I'm Maya. She's Anna. Ask: What is your name? Where are you from?

Key words

name - a word people call you

friend - a person you like and know

student - a person who learns

kind - helpful and caring

Read again. Underline one example of the language focus. Explain what it means, then write a similar sentence about yourself.

Understand and practise

Hello, world

02 / Reading comprehension

Choose the best answer, then answer the two detail questions in complete sentences.

Where is Leo from?

A. Canada / B. Italy / C. England

2. Who teaches the class?

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3. What do we know about Maya?

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03 / Language practice

Complete each sentence using the word bank. Use each entry once.

Word bank: are / is / am / are / is

1. I _____ a student.

2. She _____ from Italy.

3. We _____ in a class.

4. My name _____ Anna.

5. They _____ kind.

Make it personal: write two new sentences using the same pattern in your notebook. Check word order and verb form.

Listen, speak and write

Hello, world

04 / Listening

In the app, open this lesson and select Listening. Play the first sentence without reading. Write what you hear, then replay and check. For longer practice, use the full passage in Reading.

Second listen: choose three key words. Retell the main idea in one or two sentences. The listening script is the passage on the first page of this lesson.

05 / Speaking

> Hello. My name is Maya. I am a student.

Listen to the model, repeat it twice, then speak for 20-30 seconds about the topic. Include one personal or imaginary example. Record and listen back if possible.

Check: Are the key words clear? Are pauses natural? Did you use the target structure? Repeat once and improve one thing. Transcript matching in the app is not a pronunciation grade.

06 / Writing

Write 3 sentences about yourself. Include your name, where you are from, and what you do.

Use a notebook if you need more space. Review your response: answer the prompt, use the target language, organise ideas, check verb forms and punctuation, then revise one sentence.

Self-review: One thing I can now do / One thing I will practise again.

Things around me

LANGUAGE FOCUS / A / an & simple nouns

01 / Read and notice

This is my desk. There is a book on the desk. There is an apple next to the book. My bag is blue. Two pencils are in my bag. That is a chair. The chair is small.

Language focus

Use a before a consonant sound: a book. Use an before a vowel sound: an apple. Add -s for most plurals: one pencil, two pencils. This is near; that is farther away.

Key words

desk - a table for work

apple - a round fruit

pencil - a tool for writing

next to - beside

Read again. Underline one example of the language focus. Explain what it means, then write a similar sentence about yourself.

Understand and practise

Things around me

02 / Reading comprehension

Choose the best answer, then answer the two detail questions in complete sentences.

What is next to the book?

A. A bag / B. A chair / C. An apple

2. Where are the pencils?

3. What is blue?

03 / Language practice

Complete each sentence using the word bank. Use each entry once.

Word bank: pencils / This / is / an / a

1. This is _____ apple.

2. I have _____ book.

3. There are two _____ in my bag.

4. _____ is my desk here.

5. That _____ a chair.

Make it personal: write two new sentences using the same pattern in your notebook. Check word order and verb form.

Listen, speak and write

Things around me

04 / Listening

In the app, open this lesson and select Listening. Play the first sentence without reading. Write what you hear, then replay and check. For longer practice, use the full passage in Reading.

Second listen: choose three key words. Retell the main idea in one or two sentences. The listening script is the passage on the first page of this lesson.

05 / Speaking

> This is a book. My bag is blue.

Listen to the model, repeat it twice, then speak for 20-30 seconds about the topic. Include one personal or imaginary example. Record and listen back if possible.

Check: Are the key words clear? Are pauses natural? Did you use the target structure? Repeat once and improve one thing. Transcript matching in the app is not a pronunciation grade.

06 / Writing

Describe 4 things near you. Use a or an and at least one colour.

Use a notebook if you need more space. Review your response: answer the prompt, use the target language, organise ideas, check verb forms and punctuation, then revise one sentence.

Self-review: One thing I can now do / One thing I will practise again.

My family

LANGUAGE FOCUS / Possessives & people

01 / Read and notice

I am Ben. My sister is Ella. She is seven years old. Our mother is a doctor. Our father is a cook. His food is good. We have a cat. Its name is Coco. We live in a small house.

Language focus

My belongs to me; your belongs to you; his, her, its, our and their show belonging. Say her name, not she name. Age: She is seven years old.

Key words

sister - a female sibling

mother - a female parent

cook - a person who makes food

house - a building where people live

Read again. Underline one example of the language focus. Explain what it means, then write a similar sentence about yourself.

Understand and practise

My family

02 / Reading comprehension

Choose the best answer, then answer the two detail questions in complete sentences.

Who is a doctor?

A. Ben's mother / B. Ben's father / C. Ella

2. How old is Ella?

3. What is the cat called?

03 / Language practice

Complete each sentence using the word bank. Use each entry once.

Word bank: Its / His / My / our / Her

1. Ella is my sister. _____ name is Ella.

2. Ben is my brother. _____ name is Ben.

3. We have a cat. _____ name is Coco.

4. I am Ben. _____ father is a cook.

5. We live here. This is _____ house.

Make it personal: write two new sentences using the same pattern in your notebook. Check word order and verb form.

Listen, speak and write

My family

04 / Listening

In the app, open this lesson and select Listening. Play the first sentence without reading. Write what you hear, then replay and check. For longer practice, use the full passage in Reading.

Second listen: choose three key words. Retell the main idea in one or two sentences. The listening script is the passage on the first page of this lesson.

05 / Speaking

> My sister is Ella. Our mother is a doctor.

Listen to the model, repeat it twice, then speak for 20-30 seconds about the topic. Include one personal or imaginary example. Record and listen back if possible.

Check: Are the key words clear? Are pauses natural? Did you use the target structure? Repeat once and improve one thing. Transcript matching in the app is not a pronunciation grade.

06 / Writing

Write 4 sentences about a real or imaginary family. Use my, his and her.

Use a notebook if you need more space. Review your response: answer the prompt, use the target language, organise ideas, check verb forms and punctuation, then revise one sentence.

Self-review: One thing I can now do / One thing I will practise again.

A simple day

LANGUAGE FOCUS / Basic verbs & time

01 / Read and notice

I wake up at seven. I eat breakfast at eight. I go to school at nine. I drink water at lunch. After school, I play with my friend. I go home at four. I read a book at night.

Language focus

Use the present simple for a routine: I eat breakfast. Use at with clock times: at seven. Useful order words: first, then, after, finally.

Key words

wake up - stop sleeping

breakfast - the first meal

school - a place to learn

at night - in the dark part of the day

Read again. Underline one example of the language focus. Explain what it means, then write a similar sentence about yourself.

Understand and practise

A simple day

02 / Reading comprehension

Choose the best answer, then answer the two detail questions in complete sentences.

When does the student go home?

A. At seven / B. At four / C. At nine

2. What happens after school?

3. When is breakfast?

03 / Language practice

Complete each sentence using the word bank. Use each entry once.

Word bank: at / eat / to / at / First

1. I wake up _____ seven.

2. _____, I wake up. Then I eat.

3. I _____ breakfast at eight.

4. I go _____ school.

5. I read a book _____ night.

Make it personal: write two new sentences using the same pattern in your notebook. Check word order and verb form.

Listen, speak and write

A simple day

04 / Listening

In the app, open this lesson and select Listening. Play the first sentence without reading. Write what you hear, then replay and check. For longer practice, use the full passage in Reading.

Second listen: choose three key words. Retell the main idea in one or two sentences. The listening script is the passage on the first page of this lesson.

05 / Speaking

> I wake up at seven. I eat breakfast at eight.

Listen to the model, repeat it twice, then speak for 20-30 seconds about the topic. Include one personal or imaginary example. Record and listen back if possible.

Check: Are the key words clear? Are pauses natural? Did you use the target structure? Repeat once and improve one thing. Transcript matching in the app is not a pronunciation grade.

06 / Writing

Write your day in 4 short sentences. Include two times.

Use a notebook if you need more space. Review your response: answer the prompt, use the target language, organise ideas, check verb forms and punctuation, then revise one sentence.

Self-review: One thing I can now do / One thing I will practise again.

Level checkpoint / 1 of 2

Eight questions across meaning and language. Refer to the lesson passages for reading questions.

Choose one answer per question. Pass this practice check with at least 6 out of 8 correct. It is not an official placement or certification test.

01. Where is Leo from?

A. Canada

B. Italy

C. England

Reading reference: Lesson 1, Hello, world

02. Choose the correct sentence.

A. She are a teacher.

B. She is a teacher.

C. She am a teacher.

Language focus review

03. What is next to the book?

A. A bag

B. A chair

C. An apple

Reading reference: Lesson 2, Things around me

04. Choose the correct phrase.

A. an apple

B. a apple

C. apple an

Language focus review

Level checkpoint / 2 of 2

Eight questions across meaning and language. Refer to the lesson passages for reading questions.

Choose one answer per question. Pass this practice check with at least 6 out of 8 correct. It is not an official placement or certification test.

05. Who is a doctor?

A. Ben's mother

B. Ben's father

C. Ella

Reading reference: Lesson 3, My family

06. Complete: This is Ella. ___ name is Ella.

A. His

B. She

C. Her

Language focus review

07. When does the student go home?

A. At seven

B. At four

C. At nine

Reading reference: Lesson 4, A simple day

08. Complete: I wake up ___ seven.

A. in

B. at

C. on

Language focus review

Answer key / 1 of 2

Check after trying. Alternative wording is acceptable in open answers.

Lesson 1 / Hello, world

Reading 1: B. Italy. The text says "He is from Italy." He refers to Leo.

Reading 2: Anna teaches the class.

Reading 3: She is a student from Canada.

Language practice: 1. am; 2. is; 3. are; 4. is; 5. are

Dictation: Hello!

Lesson 2 / Things around me

Reading 1: C. An apple. An apple is next to the book. "Next to" tells us where something is.

Reading 2: They are in the bag.

Reading 3: The bag is blue.

Language practice: 1. an; 2. a; 3. pencils; 4. This; 5. is

Dictation: This is my desk.

Checkpoint answers

1. B: The text says "He is from Italy." He refers to Leo.
2. B: He and she take is.
3. C: An apple is next to the book. "Next to" tells us where something is.
4. A: Apple starts with a vowel sound.

Answer key / 2 of 2

Check after trying. Alternative wording is acceptable in open answers.

Lesson 3 / My family

Reading 1: A. Ben's mother. "Our mother is a doctor." Our refers to Ben and Ella.

Reading 2: She is seven.

Reading 3: Its name is Coco.

Language practice: 1. Her; 2. His; 3. Its; 4. My; 5. our

Dictation: I am Ben.

Lesson 4 / A simple day

Reading 1: B. At four. The sentence "I go home at four" gives the answer.

Reading 2: The student plays with a friend.

Reading 3: At eight.

Language practice: 1. at; 2. First; 3. eat; 4. to; 5. at

Dictation: I wake up at seven.

Checkpoint answers

5. A: "Our mother is a doctor." Our refers to Ben and Ella.
6. C: Her is the possessive form for she.

7. B: The sentence "I go home at four" gives the answer.
8. B: Use at with a clock time.

Review and continue

Use evidence of practice, not just a score.

Writing review

There is no single correct response to a personal writing prompt. Use this four-part review and ask a teacher or partner for feedback when possible.

Task - My response answers the prompt and gives relevant examples.

Language - I attempted the target structure and checked verb forms and word order.

Organisation - Ideas follow a clear order. At higher levels, claims have support and qualifications.

Revision - I improved one sentence after rereading or receiving feedback.

Speaking review

Focus on intelligibility, appropriate vocabulary, complete ideas and natural pauses. At Starter, short clear phrases are enough. At Advanced, support a position, respond to alternatives and choose an appropriate register.

After your checkpoint

6-8 correct: continue if the productive tasks also feel manageable.
0-5 correct: revisit the language explanations and try new examples before retaking the check.

A strong multiple-choice score alone does not demonstrate writing or speaking proficiency. Keep a portfolio of drafts and recordings.

Next step: Elementary - Talk about routines, people, places and everyday needs.